

Years 7 to 9

Can You Trust It?

Deepfakes, confident lies, and what counts as evidence now — the AI conversations Years 7–9 actually need

Which one did a person write?

a book blurb

a product review

an apology email

a whale fact

The better question

Where did it
come from?

a person?

a machine?

25 minutes core
to run

Whole class
how it works

No student devices
and no student data

Printing this? Page 1 is a dark cover, so start from page 2. The activity comes first and its cards are the last pages, printed single-sided.

This is the free preview pack for Can You Trust It?, our Years 7–9 series on deepfakes and confident wrong answers from AI. It gives you a real-or-fake challenge any teacher can run this week at no cost, and explains what the full session adds. Bookings start at \$650 for a 90-minute session.

Run this yourself

Real or Fake? — the trust challenge

A discussion challenge you run yourself in one class period. Every round is printed in this pack, so there is nothing to source and nothing to check the night before. **The one rule: SHOW, never make.** You read out examples that are already written for you. Students never generate a fake, never upload a photo, and nobody's image gets turned into anything. You are teaching them to spot fakes, not make them.

Year levels	7–9
Time	25 minutes core (15-minute compressed version: rounds 0–2 plus a short debrief; full-lesson version: add the extended discussion)
Group	Whole class
Technology	None. Every round is on paper, read aloud or copied to the board. No student devices, no accounts, no links. An optional screen round is offered at the end if you want one.
The point	Students watch their own confidence fall apart. "It sounds like a person" and "it looks real" stop being proof, and "where did it come from?" becomes the first question they ask.
Learning intention	We are learning why how something sounds or looks is not evidence of where it came from, and what to check instead.
Success criteria	I can explain why our votes went wrong. I can name a better question than "does it look real?". I can say what to do if a fake image of someone I know turns up.

The rounds are in this pack — no sourcing required

Everything you need to run this is printed below. Four paper rounds, an answer key, and a tally sheet. No links to check, no accounts, no student devices, nothing that can rot before Friday. If you want to add a screen round, there are optional ones at the end, but the lesson is complete without them.

Read each pair aloud, or copy them to the board. Students vote every round.

Before you read them, read this yourself. Every passage in the four rounds was written by an AI, Anthropic's Claude, on 21 September 2026, for this pack. For the plain version of each pair we asked for the thing itself ("a blurb for a mystery novel"). For the other version we asked for the same thing with a real place, a named person, one small flaw and a first-person voice. Nothing was edited afterwards. Don't tell the class any of this until step 4.

Round 0 — Two book blurbs for a mystery novel.

A. The morning the ferry didn't come, Dot Mallory found a library card on the jetty at Rottnest, soaked through and eleven years overdue. She is seventy-four, she has never solved anything harder than the Saturday crossword, and she has already decided she isn't telling her son.

B. In a quiet coastal town where everyone has a secret, one woman must uncover the truth before it's too late. As old wounds reopen and new dangers emerge, she discovers that the past never stays buried. A gripping, twisty mystery you won't be able to put down.

Round 1 — Two product reviews. Same pair of headphones.

A. These headphones deliver outstanding sound quality and exceptional comfort. The sleek design and long-lasting battery make them ideal for travel, work or relaxing at home. A fantastic choice for anyone who values great audio.

B. Bought these for the bus to uni because my old pair's headband snapped. Sound's good, bass is a bit much on podcasts. The right earcup clicks when I tilt my head, which I noticed on day two and now can't stop noticing. Battery lasts me the whole week.

Round 2 — Two apology emails. A local cake shop has stuffed up an order.

A. Dear valued customer, we sincerely apologise for any inconvenience caused. Your satisfaction is our top priority and we are committed to providing an exceptional experience. We appreciate your patience and understanding as we work to resolve this matter.

B. Hi Priya, that's on us. We sent the small box instead of the large one because I read your order too fast on Friday. The right cake goes out this afternoon at no charge and I've refunded the delivery. If anything's still wrong, ring the shop and ask for Tom.

Round 3 – The confident lie. This one is different. Both passages are about the same topic, and one of them contains something invented. Your students are hunting the invention, not the style.

A. Humpback whales travel along the Western Australian coast every year, heading north to warmer water to breed and calve, then back south to feed. It is one of the longest migrations of any mammal, and in season they can often be seen from headlands along the coast.

B. Humpback whales travel along the Western Australian coast every year. A 2019 study by the Coastal Cetacean Research Institute found that 94% of them now travel within 12 kilometres of the shore, a change the researchers link to warming water.

The answer key (for you, not the board)

Round	Who wrote it	What to draw out
0	An AI wrote both.	A came from asking for a real place, a named person and one odd detail. The detail is what convinced the room. Detail is cheap to ask for now.
1	An AI wrote both.	B came from asking for one small complaint, a reason for buying and no big adjectives. A flaw used to be a sign a person wrote something. It can be ordered.
2	An AI wrote both.	B came from asking it to admit one specific mistake, name a person and offer a fix. Ask which one they'd rather receive. That's a fair question, and it tells you nothing about who wrote it.
3	B contains the invention.	The institute, the study, the 94% and the 12 kilometres are all made up for this exercise. This is the important round. B <i>sounds</i> more credible than A precisely because it has numbers and a source. A made-up source is the most convincing thing a machine can hand you, and the only defence is checking that the source exists.

Do not skip the debrief on Round 3. Ask directly: "Which one sounded more trustworthy?" Most rooms say B. Then tell them B was the one with the invention, and that the numbers were what sold it.

Sitting in that for ten seconds is the most useful part of the lesson.

Optional – add a screen round

If you have time and want a visual round, these are established public resources built for exactly this purpose. Check the link the week you run it, because these move.

Round	Example type	Where to look
Faces	AI-generated face vs real photograph	Search " Which Face Is Real University of Washington " – a public research/education project presenting exactly this challenge.
Images	AI image vs real news photograph	Several major news organisations run "can you spot the AI image?" quizzes. Search a trusted outlet (ABC, BBC, Guardian) plus " AI image quiz ", which means the vetting and answers are done for you.
Voices	Synthetic voice vs real recording	Search " audio deepfake quiz " plus a news outlet. Save it for late in the lesson.

If you add a screen round, vet it against this checklist:

- You know which item is which and where both came from. Provenance is the lesson, so you must be able to answer "how do we know?"
- No student, staff member or local community member appears in anything.
- Real people appear only in already-public material: public figures, consenting subjects, published news photography.
- Nothing distressing, degrading or sexualised. If in doubt, swap it out.

How to run it

Two minutes of setup makes everyone a player. Each student tears a scrap of paper in two and writes A on one piece and B on the other. Those are their vote cards, and everyone votes every round. Then hand out three jobs that rotate each round: one student counts the A cards, one counts the B cards, one keeps the tally sheet.

1 Set the frame and take the first count

"Each round I'll read you two short pieces of writing. Your job is to vote on which one a person wrote." Don't say that either of them was. Then: "**Hands up if you reckon you can tell a person's writing from an AI's.**" The tally keeper counts the hands and writes the number down. Don't comment on it.

2

Round 0, the book blurbs

Read both aloud. Thirty seconds in pairs: which one did a person write, and one reason why. All cards up on your count of three. Counters count, the tally keeper records, and you write the room's reason on the board. Don't reveal anything yet.

3

Rounds 1 and 2, the reviews and the apologies

Same drill, and keep adding reasons to the board. They'll be things like "it has details", "it admits a mistake", "it sounds like a real person". Most rooms pick the same letter every time, and they'll be sure.

4

The reveal

"Every one of those six pieces was written by an AI. The ones you picked came from asking it for a place, a name and a small flaw." Then point at the reasons on the board, one at a time: **"Could you ask a machine for this one?"** Let the room answer each. The things that felt like evidence were style, and style can be ordered.

5

Round 3, the confident lie

Change the instruction before you read it: **"This round is different. Both of these are about whales. One of them contains something that was made up. Find it."** Read both. Vote. Then ask the question that matters before you reveal: **"Which one sounded more trustworthy?"** Take a show of hands. Most rooms pick B, the one with the study, the percentage and the distance. Then reveal that B contains the invention and that the numbers were what sold it.

6

Land the link

Don't explain it, ask for it: **"What have all four rounds got in common?"** Take pair answers until someone gets there: something can sound human, detailed and confident, and even name a source, and still not be what it seems. Then say the line: a machine that will invent a research institute will invent a homework answer.

7

Take the second count

"Hands up if you still reckon you can tell." The tally keeper writes it next to the first number. The difference between those two numbers is what the class just learned. Then run the debrief.

The tally sheet (print or copy to the board)

Jobs, rotating each round: A counter · B counter · tally keeper.

Before we start, "I can tell a person's writing from an AI's": _____ hands

Round	Voted A	Voted B	The reason we gave	Revealed
0 – book blurbs				
1 – headphone reviews				
2 – apology emails				
3 – the whales				
Optional screen round				

After the last round, "I can still tell": _____ hands

The spoken teaching point (say it out loud, at the end)

"You just watched your own judgement get it wrong, round after round, and every reason you gave was something a machine can be asked for. 'It sounds like a person' and 'it looks real' used to be good enough. They aren't anymore. So the skill now is asking where something came from, not how it sounds."

Debrief questions

Run each one pairs-first: 30 seconds with a neighbour, then take hands.

- Which round fooled the most of us? Why that one?
- "It sounds like a real person." After today, what does that actually prove?
- If sounding real isn't proof anymore, what is? (*Draw out: the source, where it came from, a second independent confirmation. "It was on the internet" is not a source.*)
- A sexual or humiliating picture of someone you know turns up in a group chat. What do you do? (*Don't pass it on and don't save it. Tell an adult you trust: a teacher, a parent, someone at school. It may not even be real, and it is just as serious if it isn't. Making a sexual image of anyone under 18 is illegal in Australia, and that includes using an AI tool. The school can report it to police, and eSafety can have it taken down: esafety.gov.au/report.*)
- A voice note that sounds exactly like your mum asks you to do something odd. What's the move? (*Check on another channel: ring her on the number you already have. The voice is no longer proof.*)

Before you run the debrief. If a student tells you this has happened to them or to someone they know, follow your school's child protection procedures. The eSafety Commissioner's advice to schools is that anything of a criminal nature goes to local police first, then to eSafety, which can have the material removed (eSafety Commissioner, 26 June 2025).

If it stalls

- **The room catches on early ("they're both AI!").** Good. Ask what gave it away, write it on the board, then read Round 3 and see whether that rule still helps them.
- **The optional screen round fails.** Skip it. The paper rounds carry the lesson on their own.
- **A student goes nihilist: "so nothing's real, why care?"** Don't argue. Hand it to the room: **"Is that right? Is nothing real?"** Someone will push back; back them up. Plenty is real, and checking sources is how you find it. Journalists, courts and scientists earn trust that way for a living. The skill is trust you can check, not doubting everything.
- **Someone asks "can we make one?"** The answer is no, and this is where the SHOW-never-make rule earns its keep. A fake of a real person can hurt them badly, a sexual one of anyone under 18 is a crime, and the skill that will actually serve them is spotting and checking. (The full session covers what the law says, at an age-appropriate level.)

What this series is

The big question: *Can you trust what you see, and can you trust what you make?*

The honest bit first. If you want a free "how AI works" hour for Years 7–10, WADSIH (the WA Data Science Innovation Hub, at Curtin) runs a good one, and we're glad it exists. We don't compete with it. **This series is about everything that hour never touches** — the stuff that actually worries Year 9 coordinators:

1. **What it actually is** — thirty seconds of honest demystifying: a pattern engine, not magic and not a brain. Then we move on, because that part you can get for free.
2. **Where it breaks** — it makes things up, and it says false things *confidently*. Students watch a real example of a confident wrong answer and learn the word for it.
3. **Deepfakes and trust** — show, never make. A real-versus-fake challenge the room mostly can't win. What does that do to "I saw it with my own eyes"?
4. **Your work** — using AI to help versus using it to cheat, where the line actually sits, and what using it well looks like.
5. **Digital citizenship** — students will make and share this stuff. What's fair to make, what isn't, and what the law already says about fake images of real people.

The main activity of the full session is BUILD IT: the class writes an AI assistant's safety rules, then tries to break them. Some attempts fail. One works. Students see for themselves that an assistant's rules are written by people, in words, and that the right wording can slip past them. So "the AI promised" isn't a guarantee, and trust has to come from somewhere else.

Our integrity stance, in one line: detectors do not reliably work; design beats detection. We say it plainly to students and to staff, because it's true — a school that acts on a detector's verdict is standing on ground that won't hold. We'd rather tell you that now than have you find it out the hard way.

In the longer formats, two people deliver it: a working AI practitioner who builds these systems for commercial clients, and a registered teacher who runs the room.

The safety promise — in every C4Site session, without exception

- No student devices.
- No student data entered into any system — ever.
- No student images saved, generated or uploaded.
- A school staff member present throughout.
- Where a camera is used, it points at objects the class holds up — never at faces.
- Everything runs on our own device and our own connection, never your school network.

What the full session adds (honestly)

This challenge is real value, and you can run it forever without us. Here's what changes when we're in the room:

In this pack	In the full session
Four printed rounds	A pre-vetted, escalating deck we build and keep current — including the synthetic-audio rounds, which are the hardest to source well — with the rounds ordered so the confidence drop lands on schedule
Hallucination <i>described</i> , via reporting	Hallucination <i>demonstrated live</i> on the presenter's own machine — the room watches a confident wrong answer happen
The discussion of trust	The BUILD IT moment: your students write an AI assistant's guardrails on the big screen, try to break them, and watch one attempt get through. They learn that a rule written in words can be talked around, by doing it
The integrity line, stated	The integrity conversation, had properly: why detectors don't reliably work, where the line between help and cheating actually sits, and what using AI well looks like for <i>their</i> assessments
The law, in one line	What the law says about fake images of real people, at an age-appropriate level, from a presenter who is studying law
One teacher running one activity	All five steps of the session, and in the longer formats two presenters: a working AI practitioner and a registered teacher
This pack	A teacher resource pack you keep: pre-session primer, teacher-facing run sheet, post-session activities and the curriculum mapping

Where it sits in the curriculum

An incursion **connects to and enriches** the curriculum — it doesn't deliver a descriptor to the achievement standard on its own, and we won't claim it does. For Years 7–8 the series speaks most directly to the lines below.

In the Western Australian curriculum

WA schools teach SCSA's Western Australian Curriculum, which is adapted from the Australian Curriculum and has its own codes. These are the WA content descriptions this series supports, in SCSA's words.

WA code	Year	Content description (SCSA, verbatim)
WA8DIGAD2	Year 8	Evaluate the authenticity, accuracy and timeliness of acquired data
WA8DIGPS1	Year 8	Ethical issues relating to the collection and ownership of data
WA7DIGPS1	Year 7	Issues relating to a user's digital footprint and the permanence of data
WA9DIGDR1	Year 9	Different methods of manipulation and storage of data

SCSA's own examples for WA8DIGAD2 and WA9DIGDR1 name deepfakes.

Source: SCSA, Pre-primary to Year 10 Digital Technologies Syllabus (k10outline.scsa.wa.edu.au), read 19 September 2026.

In the Australian Curriculum v9 (Digital Technologies), which WA's is adapted from:

Code	Descriptor	How this series connects
AC9TDI8K03	investigate how digital systems represent text, image and audio data using integers	Images and voices are just data — which is exactly why they can be synthesised, and exactly why "it looks real" proves nothing.
AC9TDI8P14	investigate and manage the digital footprint existing systems and student solutions collect and assess if the data is essential to their purpose	The digital-citizenship step: what you make, share and feed into systems, and what it costs you.
AC9TDI8P10	evaluate existing and student solutions against the design criteria, user stories and possible future impact	Judging what's fair to make and share, and what it does to real people.

The heavier lifting sits in the **general capabilities** at this band (Level 5): **Digital Literacy** (finding and judging information — telling credible from unreliable sources is the deepfake skill), **Ethical Understanding**, and **Critical and Creative Thinking**. The series is also built to be consistent with the **Australian Framework for Generative AI in Schools** — particularly its *Human and Social Wellbeing*, *Transparency*, and *Privacy, Security and Safety* principles.

The full descriptor-by-descriptor mapping lives in the C4Site Curriculum Alignment Matrix, which every student-facing booking receives.

Where we stand on AI

You are about to put this in front of children, so you are entitled to know what the people who wrote it actually think.

We are not AI evangelists. Caleb uses these tools most working days and still would not call himself a fan. It is a drill: you pick it up when it suits the job and put it down when it doesn't. The moment it starts doing your thinking instead of your work, it has stopped being useful. That is the view underneath every one of these packs, and it is why the activities are built to make students sceptical rather than impressed.

Two things we think schools should keep well away from it: **creativity and judgement**. Drafting is labour and a machine can carry some of it. Deciding is different, and a student who never sits in the not-knowing does not build the muscle that hard problems need later. The struggle was the point of the lesson.

What that means for a C4Site session, without exception:

- No student devices. Everything hands-on is unplugged, or driven by the presenter.
- No student data is entered into any system, ever.
- No student images are saved, shared or shown. The camera frames only the objects students hold up.
- A school staff member is present throughout.
- The tool runs on the presenter's own device and hotspot, never your network.

And the thing schools least enjoy hearing from us: AI detectors do not reliably work. They flag honest work as cheating and wave real AI writing straight through, and the students who cop it worst are often the ones who speak English as a second language. We will not sell you one, and we will say so in front of your staff. What does work is changing how the task is set, and that is teachable.

All of it is published, dated, and open to being checked: **c4studios.com.au/how-we-use-ai**

If your school would rather keep AI outside the fence entirely, that is a fair position and we will not argue you out of it. We would rather you knew where we stood before you booked us than after.

Bring the full series to your school

No GST is added, as C4 Studios is not registered for GST · Perth metro · two presenters unless noted.

Format	What it is	Reaches	Price
90-Minute Incursion	One 90 min session (one presenter), your own teacher in the room	Up to 60	\$650
Single Year Group	2 × 60 min sessions (one presenter)	Up to 60	\$950
Half Day	3 sessions	Up to 90	\$1,750
Full Day	5 sessions + a free 45-min after-school staff briefing	Up to 150	\$2,850
Term Program	6 weekly sessions with one year group, ending in a student showcase	One year group	\$7,500

Single Year Group, Half Day and Full Day bookings include the teacher resource pack. A student day can be paired with **Staff PD (\$2,200, or \$3,400 extended)**. It comes out of a different budget line, and it helps when staff and students hear the same honest story about integrity.

Or start free

Book the free 30-minute Taster. One class or a short assembly, one presenter, no cost. The rules: one per school, ever; a decision-maker (Principal, Deputy, HOLA or Digital Technologies coordinator) in the room; and it ends with a scheduled conversation about where AI fits at your school.

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Who you'd be booking. You don't have to take our word for anything. Things you can check yourself: we run a Perth studio building AI automation for commercial clients — real, current work. Our practitioner is a UWA JD (law) student, so the ethics, consent and regulation content is genuine, not borrowed. And we deliver alongside a TRBWA-registered teacher.

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